

PARENT PLAYBOOK

4 ways to raise an opportunity-spotter

Want to raise an entrepreneur? Dhirubhai Ambani started with almost nothing and built an empire. Here's how to teach your child to spot opportunity and create value early.

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The quick answer

What is an entrepreneurial mindset? It's the habit of looking at the world and asking, 'What do people need, and how could I provide it?' It blends curiosity, problem-solving, courage, and resourcefulness. A child with this mindset doesn't just wait for opportunities - they learn to see and create them, in any career they choose.

DO THIS

4 ways to raise an opportunity-spotter

Work through these in order. Small, daily reps beat one big push.

1

Play the 'what do people need?' game. On a walk, ask

'What's a problem you see here? How could someone fix it?' Train the eye to spot needs.

2

Let them earn, not just receive

Tie some money to a small job or a tiny venture - lemonade, crafts, a service. Earning teaches value like nothing else.

3

Teach the 'bit on top'

Help them work out what something costs to make and add a margin. That 'bit on top' is profit - their first business lesson.

4

Let them pitch and hear 'no'

Have them ask for the sale, look someone in the eye, and survive a no. Courage and communication are the real skills.

PARENT FAQ

Quick answers

How young can I start teaching entrepreneurship?

Earlier than you'd think. Children grasp 'I made something people wanted, and they paid for it' from around age five or six, and core money habits form by about seven. Start with simple, playful ventures - a stall, a small service - and let the lessons grow with them.

Isn't pushing money and business too much for a child?

It's not about pressure or profit - it's about mindset. The goal is curiosity, problem-solving, and confidence: noticing what people need and having the courage to act. Done playfully, it builds agency and self-belief, not stress. The money is just the teaching tool.

What's the simplest way to build an entrepreneurial mindset?

Play the 'what do people need?' game on everyday walks, and let your child earn a little by doing a small job or running a tiny venture. Spotting needs and creating value to meet them is the whole skill, and it grows through real, small experiences.

My child is shy - can they still be entrepreneurial?

Absolutely, and it can help them grow. Starting small - selling to family, then a neighbour - lets a shy child build courage and communication gradually. Surviving a gentle 'no' and making a small 'sale' does more for confidence than almost anything else.

Why does spotting opportunity matter for my child's future?

Because the world is shifting from safe jobs to created value. The most rewarded skills of the coming decade are spotting problems, inventing solutions, and resilience. A child who learns to see and create opportunity will thrive in any career, not just business.

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